

fpdf2: Simple PDF Generation

What is fpdf2?

fpdf2 is a pure Python library for PDF generation with a simple, straightforward API. It's lightweight, has no external dependencies, and is perfect for basic to moderate PDF generation needs. You control positioning manually, giving you precise control over layout.

Why Use fpdf2?

- [OK] Pure Python - No system dependencies
- [OK] Simple API - Easy to learn and use
- [OK] Lightweight - Small footprint
- [OK] Manual Control - Precise positioning
- [OK] Good for Basic PDFs - Perfect for simple documents
- [OK] Active Development - Well-maintained project

How It Works

fpdf2 uses a canvas-based approach where you set fonts, colors, and positions, then draw text, shapes, and images. You manually control page breaks and positioning, giving you complete control but requiring more code for complex layouts.

Basic Example:

```
from fpdf import FPDF

pdf = FPDF()
pdf.add_page()
pdf.set_font('Arial', 'B', 16)
pdf.cell(40, 10, 'Hello World!')
pdf.output('output.pdf')
```

Best Use Cases

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[OK] Simple documents with basic formatting

[OK] When you need minimal dependencies

[OK] Quick PDF generation for simple reports

[OK] Embedded systems or constrained environments

[OK] Learning PDF generation basics

Limitations & Considerations

[!] **Manual positioning required - more code for complex layouts**

[!] **Limited automatic text flow - must handle wrapping yourself**

[!] **Basic typography support - no advanced features**

[!] **No CSS/template support - must code everything**

Installation

```
pip install fpdf2
```

No system dependencies required - pure Python!